

iPad Mini, Galaxy SIII Mini, ASUS Padfone2 and more launches

The mobile space is always packed with action each month. October was no different. Also there are over a billion smartphone users in the world now

It's been a period of waiting, and unfortunately, none of it is over. There have been some new invitations issued as well since we last met. At the time of writing, all expected major revelations still lamentably lie in the future – including the first batch of Windows Phone 8 devices (October 29), and the Android mystery reveal (October 29).

On a side note, the accompanying tablet sphere is heating up quite a bit, with the introduction of the first Windows 8 (with the shared NT kernel) tablets – starting with Microsoft's Surface for Windows RT offering in late October. If you get your magazine late, blame the iPad Mini, because it launched just as we were about to go to print. The possible 10-inch or ultra-low cost Nexus tablets from Google at the Android mystery event stand to make things even more interesting in the smartphone-tablet ecosystem.

With some big announcements, including a few in the Indian space, it's not all frustration. The iPhone 5 has seen brisk business on the grey market and the online front here, whilst being officially benchmarked as the most powerful smartphone yet – despite its startling 7.6 mm thickness. The iPhone 5 also has other records, with more than 5 million units sold in the first week. The massive iPhone 5 competition base now really has a lot to live up to – at least on the engineering front.

iPad mini is finally here

The much-rumoured and talked about mini version of the iPad was finally released by Apple on October 23. The 7.9-inch Apple iPad mini was announced along with the 13-inch Retina Display MacBook Pro, the new iMac (both sporting Ivy Bridge processors) and a more powerful 4th generation iPad.



Apple iPad Mini

The iPad mini has a 7.9-inch panel with 1024x768 resolution and measures just 7.5 mm on the sides. It sports the new Lightning connector so that you have to buy all new accessories and spend even more.

Pricing starts at \$329 for the 16GB Wi-Fi version. The 32GB Wi-Fi is \$429, while the 64GB will be \$529. The Wi-Fi plus cellular versions will be \$459 (16GB), \$559 (32GB), and \$659 (64GB).

since everyone loves percentages: the iPad mini is 23 per cent thinner and 53 per cent lighter than its 9.7-inch counterpart. "It's as thin as a pencil,"

Apple's Phil Schiller said, but we've seen thinner pencils, to be honest.

Schiller said the Apple team "worked really hard" thinking about the size of the iPad mini, which probably means a lot of coffee breaks and real-world paper toss championships. Anyway, they say they have iPad that is capable of running existing apps, but isn't so small "that it stops being incredibly usable."

"All the software made for the iPad works on the mini with no change," Schiller said.

Schiller compared the iPad mini to existing Android tablets, criticizing its rivals for using plastic materials, only making the screen 7 inches, and not having as many apps. "There is a gigantic difference in these products," he said. "They have phone applications stretched up, not tablet applications."

The iPad mini runs a dual-core A5 processor from Apple. It supports FaceTime HD and features and a 5-megapixel iSight camera. There's LTE connectivity, as well as 802.11 a/b/g/n Wi-Fi. Apple promised 10 hours of battery life.

Apple is also offering new polyurethane Smart Covers for the iPad mini in pink, green, blue, light gray, dark gray and red for \$39, but you'd be better off waiting for Chinese ripoffs at a quarter of the price.

Read the hands-on with the iPad Mini here: <http://dgit.in/WKGuaO>

Windows Phone 8 – a refresher

While Windows Phone 8 is not yet out in the market, we thought we'd also jog your memory of what changes the new platform will bring, just in case you forget all about them.

Windows Phone 8 finally supports the multi-core chipsets, and the first batch from Samsung, Nokia and HTC all show off dual-core processors. All WP8 devices will get Internet Explorer 10. They will share native code with Windows 8, bringing ease of porting, shared APIs and libraries, and enterprise-level hardware features. NFC (including mobile wallet) and Bluetooth support will be up-to-date. Microsoft is also finally adding microSD card support with Windows Phone 8.

All Windows Phone 8 devices will feature Nokia Maps powered by NAVTEQ data. They will offer turn-by-turn voice navigation and offline



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